Reihaneh Farzinnia

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Research Interests

- ◇ Mental health and wellbeing measurement.
- ◇ Psychometrics.

Education

- ◇ **Ph.D. in Education**. The University of Manchester, UK.
  (October 2024–present)
  - ○ **Supervisors:** Prof. Neil Humphrey and Dr. Louise Black
  - **Ph.D. topic:** Advancing the measurement of mental health and wellbeing in young people: measurement invariance, careless responding, and response shifts.
- ◇ **M.Sc. in Research Methods with Education**. The University of Manchester, UK.
  (September 2023–September 2024)
  - ○ **Supervisors:** Prof. Neil Humphrey and Dr. Louise Black
  - **Overall grade:** 77.4 (Distinction)
  - **Dissertation topic:** A cross-lagged panel network model to document the relationships between risk factor exposure and internalising symptoms in early-to-mid adolescence.
- ◇ **B.Sc. in Educational Psychology**. The University of Manchester, UK.
  (September 2019–June 2022)
  - ○ **Supervisor:** Prof. Michael Wigelsworth
  - **Overall grade:** 77.3 (First Class with Honours)
  - **Dissertation topic:** How adolescents' emotion regulation goals and beliefs affect or predict the use of cognitive reappraisal and expressive suppression.

Research Experience

- ◇ **Research Assistant at So.Me, The University of Manchester**.
  (June 2024–present)
  - ○ **Supervisors:** Dr. Margarita Panayiotou, Dr. Louise Black, and Dr. Jo Hickman-Dunne
  - Cleaning baseline and intensive longitudinal Ecological Momentary Assessment data; supportting the development of a youth-informed measure of social media experience and the preparation of quantitative manuscripts.
- ◇ **Research Assistant for Dr. Ola Demkowicz's girls' mental health and wellbeing grant, The University of Manchester**.
  (February 2026–June 2026)
  - ○ **Supervisor:** Dr. Ola Demkowicz
  - Reviewed intersectionality methodologies and compared UK cohort studies by their measures, samples, and longitudinal designs to inform a robust quantitative research strategy.
- ◇ **Research Assistant at BeeWell, The University of Manchester**.
  (April 2023–September 2023)
  - ○ **Supervisor:** Prof. Neil Humphrey

- Supported the development of a large-scale adolescent survey across schools in Hampshire and the Isle of Wight and contributed to a longitudinal study of sleep, physical activity, and mental wellbeing.

◇ **Research Assistant at The University of Manchester**.
(July 2022–January 2023)

- **Supervisors:** Dr. Rebecca Jefferson and Prof. Pamela Qualter
- Supported the evaluation of the DfE Early Identification of Autism Project through ethics preparation, focus-group moderation, and systematic qualitative data analysis.

◇ **Research Intern at BeeWell, The University of Manchester**.
(July 2022–November 2022)

- **Supervisors:** Dr. Louise Black and Prof. Neil Humphrey
- Audited R code using simulated data to verify reproducibility and contributed to a quantitative paper on network-level variation in adolescent mental-health risk.

◇ **Research Assistant at Fit2Belong, The University of Manchester**.
(January 2022–April 2022)

- **Supervisors:** Dr. Rebecca Jefferson and Prof. Pamela Qualter
- Collected and prepared research data by facilitating and transcribing focus groups for programme evaluation.

Publications

Peer-reviewed journal articles

◇ Jefferson, R., Farzinnia, R., Verity, L., Jones, F., Fayette, R., Qualter, P., Woods, K., & Bond, C. (2026). Evaluation of context-specific early identification of autism models involving multiple stakeholders: Examples from three areas of England. *Journal of Autism and Developmental Disorders*, 1-12. doi.org/10.1007/s10803-026-07589-6

◇ Marquez, J., Panayiotou, M., Farzinnia, R., Cheng, Q., & Humphrey, N. (2025). Correction: Longitudinal relationships across sleep, physical activity, and mental wellbeing in early-to-mid-adolescence: a developmental cascades investigation. *Quality of Life Research: An International Journal of Quality of Life Aspects of Treatment, Care and Rehabilitation*, *34*(5), 1233-1250. doi.org/10.1007/s11136-025-03921-2

◇ Black, L., Farzinnia, R., Humphrey, N., & Marquez, J. (2024). Variation in global network properties across risk factors for adolescent internalizing symptoms: evidence of cumulative effects on structure and connectivity. *Psychological medicine*, *54*(4), 687–697. `https://doi.org/10.1017/S0033291723002362`

Preprints

◇ Farzinnia, R., Black, L., Santos, J. G. A. d., & Humphrey, N. (2026). A moderated nonlinear factor analysis workflow for detecting and estimating multiple sources of differential item functioning and evaluating their impact on scale scores. osf.io/preprints/psyarxiv/wdc2h_v1

◇ Farzinnia, R., Black, L., & Humphrey, N. (2026). A cross-lagged panel network model to document the relationships between psychosocial risk factor exposure and internalising symptoms in early-to-mid adolescence. `https://osf.io/preprints/psyarxiv/y3w8a_v2`

◇ Hickman Dunne, J., Black, L., Davies, J., Jones, F., Anderton, M., Nanda, P., Beissel, F., Bruke, L., Farzinnia, R., & Panayiotou, M. (2026). Developing an adolescent self-report measure of social media experience: Insights from cognitive interviews. `https://osf.io/preprints/psyarxiv/uzrc9_v1`

◇ Hickman Dunne, J., Burke, L., Davies, J., Black, L., Jones, F., Anderton, M., Nanda, P., Beissel, F., Farzinnia, R., & Panayiotou, M. (2026). Planning on doing cognitive interviews?

Reflections and recommendations from the So.Me study. https://osf.io/preprints/psyarxiv/8xv2c_v1

◇ Cameron, L., Farzinnia, R., Cheng, Q., Jenkins, R., & Humphrey, N. (2025). The association between school staff support and wellbeing for students with poor quality social relationships. doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/sah9r_v1

Teaching Experience

◇ **Graduate Teaching Assistant at The University of Manchester**
(January 2025–present)

- Supporting lectures and practicals for the M.Sc. quantitative research unit.

◇ **English as a Second Language (ESL) Teacher at the NooreMobin Institution**
(November 2017–August 2019)

- Delivered three ESL sessions per week, designing lesson plans, activities, games, and supporting materials. Maintained student progress records to inform meetings with staff and parents.

Conference Presentations

◇ **APS 2026 – Poster presentation.** *Evaluating the Measurement Invariance of Adolescent Internalising Symptoms Using Integrative Data Analysis and Regularized Moderated Nonlinear Factor Analysis.*

◇ **SAA 2026 – Poster presentation.** *Designing and Delivering Ecological Momentary Assessment for Adolescent Social Media Research: Event-Contingent App Development and Feasibility Lessons from a UK Study.*

Memberships of Committees

◇ **Ex Officio Graduate Student Member of the Society for the Improvement of Psychological Science**.
(January 2026–January 2028)

Volunteer Experience

◇ **Project Leader of the Reading Mentors, The University of Manchester**.
(December 2019–June 2022)

- Led and organised reading-mentoring sessions while monitoring children's progress. Collected feedback from families and the school to support ongoing programme improvement.

Skills

◇ **Quantitative methods:** Integrative data analysis, moderated nonlinear factor analysis, measurement invariance testing, network modelling, multilevel modelling, and item response theory.

◇ **Data analysis and programming:** R, Jamovi, and NVivo.

◇ **Typesetting and document preparation:** LaTeX, TeX, and Microsoft Word.

◇ **Languages:** Farsi (native) and English (fluent).

Awards

◇ **Faculty of Humanities PGT Dean's Award for Achievement.**
Issued by The University of Manchester.

◇ **Platt Prize.**
Issued by The University of Manchester.

◇ **BeeWell 1+3 Studentship.**
Issued by The University of Manchester.

- ◇ **Faculty of Humanities Dean's Award for Achievement.**
  Issued by The University of Manchester.
- ◇ **Volunteer of the Year Awards, Student Category: 2nd Place.**
  Issued by The University of Manchester.
- ◇ **Make A Difference Award.**
  Outstanding Contribution to Widening Participation and Outstanding Local/Civic Engagement.

References

- ◇ Available upon request.